Turning a hybrid pen blank from red mallee burl with blue, white and red resin

PHOTOGRAPH COURTESY OF LDDREMWORK

Statesman pen kit with cocobolo wood

Finished pen made with cholla cactus wood and turquoise stones

LIKES

- My Killinger
- Finding the time to go in my workshop
- Working with new materials
- Creating new things
- Seeing the result of my work

DISLIKES

- Bad tools
- Not having enough time for woodturning
- Sanding
- Selling my pens

HANDY HINTS

- Get creative, by turning pens in all kinds of materials
- Take the time and make it exact. The results will be unbelievable

What methods of promotion do you use?

My biggest promotion by far is through personal recommendation. After this, I try to use profiling in magazines and on the internet. Most of the time the groups of pens I make sell out just after I've finished them and so you don't see them too much on my homepage

What are your aims and aspirations for the future?

To find more time for woodturning, building a complete package with a box and a place to keep the pens. I like people to value my work and for it to make them happy

Typically, how long does it take you to complete one of your pieces?

Normally, I make a set of 10 to 15 pens in one go. I spend most of my time finding out which wood goes with which pen kit. Then I start to sign them, cut them, trill them, turn them, sand them, put the finish on and marry them. This takes around two weeks, working every evening for two or three hours and most of the weekend. If I'm doing contract work, it takes about five to six hours, without the finish drying time

What special tools in your workshop could you not do without?

I can't do without my Killinger lathe, my wet sharpening machine and the Henry Taylor Working tools

Can you tell us a bit about a typical day in your life?

In the morning I wake up at 5 o'clock and go to work. When I come home from work, I go down in the basement where my workshop is and start woodturning for two or three hours. I also need my free days. Once my wife comes back from work, we cook together and talk about the day, what happened and the ideas we've had. After a time without woodturning, I want to turn. So I start again ●

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